(iii) Matters for the consideration of which machinery is established by any special statute under which a particular public undertaking is established

Further, the effectiveness of the role of the committee is limited by the following:

(a) It cannot take up the examination of more than ten to twelve public undertakings in a year.

(b) Its work is in the nature of a post-mortem.

(c) It does not look into technical matters as its members are not technical experts.

(d) Its recommendations are advisory and not binding on the ministries.

DEPARTMENT-RELATED STANDING COMMITTEES

On the recommendation of the Rules Committee of the Lok Sabha, 17 Department-Related Standing Committees (DRSCs) were set up in the Parliament in 1993.[4] In 2004, seven more such committees were setup, thus increasing their number from 17 to 24.

The main objective of the DRSCs is to secure more accountability of the Executive (i.e., the Council of Ministers) to the Parliament, particularly financial accountability. They also assist the Parliament in debating the budget more effectively.[5] The 24 DRSCs cover under their jurisdiction all the ministries/departments of the Central Government.

Each DRSC consists of 31 members (21 from Lok Sabha and 10 from Rajya Sabha). The members of the Lok Sabha are nominated by the Speaker from amongst its own members, just as the members of the Rajya Sabha are nominated by the Chairman from amongst its members.[6] A minister is not eligible to be nominated as a member of any of the DRSCs. In case a member, after his/her nomination to any of the DRSCs, is appointed a minister, he/she then ceases to be a member of the committee. The term of office of each DRSC is one year from the date of its constitution.

Table 24.1 Department-Related Standing Committees and their Jurisdiction

Sl. No.	Name of the Committees	Ministries/Departments Covered
I. Committees under Rajya Sabha		
1.	Committee on Commerce	Commerce and Industry
2.	Committee on Home Affairs	(1) Home Affairs (2) Development of North-Eastern Region
3.	Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports	(1) Education